

NEW ORLEANS CLUB RED-HOT . . . If we were asked the straight question of who has the best club in the Southern Association at the present time, we would have to say New Orleans. . . . Andy Cohen's red-hot Pelicans have been the talk of the league since right before the All-Star game.

Perched next to Montgomery in seventh place on July 22, the Pelicans have set a terrific pace in the AA Southern circuit since that time . . . They have won 27 of 36 games and are now in fourth place, only a game and a half out of third and only five and a half games back of the leading Atlanta club.

New Orleans opened the season with a bang and they have had good hitting all season but they sagged when their pitching fell. In recent weeks the Pirates sent them Curt Raydon and the mound staff rallied and is now doing a good job. As a result the Louisiana club is setting a terrific winning pace . . .

Cohen has had four good .300 hitters all season in outfielders Gail Henley, .321; Emil Panko, .302, and John Powers, .316, and first baseman Al Grunwald, .324 . . . The four sluggers have accounted for 77 home runs between them . . . Powers currently has 28 and Panko is next with 27 . . .

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